

Fair Affair

Nandigram is back in the news, this time for the right reasons. Bollywood stars will be visiting the ghost village for a fair being organised by first-time Trinamool Congress MP Subhendu Adhikari. The fair is being planned as an eight-day affair to bring back the spirit of cheer in Nandigram. On the agenda are a series of film shows, theatre festivals and even a circus. It is not yet known which Bollywood stars will be attending, but it is certain that they will be big names given Mamata Banerjee's newly found nationwide clout. Villagers have been roped in by Trinamool activists to sell their handicrafts at the fair. Adhikari is trying to involve big corporates to Nandigram to do business during the festival in a place which has been given up by all parties, the Government included. Obviously, all the Bengal celebrities who have pitched for the Trinamool Congress will be out in full swing. It's glamour time in Nandigram.

by Abhijit Dasgupta

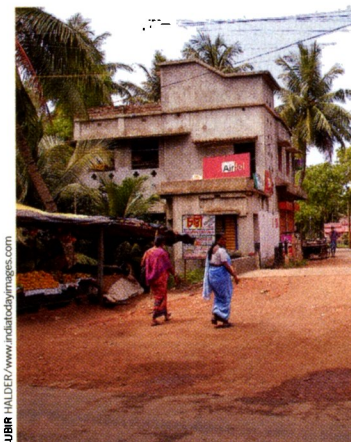


INHERITED FATE

A PHYSIOTHERAPIST holds the foot of a seven-year-old child at a clinic in Bhopal that treats victims of the 1984 gas tragedy. A quarter of a century after thousands died in the gas leak, congenital defects continue to mar the next generation.

Dead Story

The death of a senior IAS officer in Lucknow and the silence of his colleagues has set rumours ablaze. The body of Harminder Raj Singh, principal secretary for housing in the state Government, was found next to his licenced revolver. The Lucknow police closed the case in 12 hours, calling it a suicide caused by "high blood pressure" from job stress.



NANDIGRAM VILLAGE